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NMAM INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY, NITTE
Off-Campus Centre of Nitte(Deemed to be University)
Seventh Semester B.Tech (CBCS) Degree Examinations

December 2025

HU1506-1 – OVERVIEW OF INDIAN CULTURE

(Open Elective)

Duration: 3 Hours

Max. Marks:100

Note:

Part – A: Multiple Choice Questions: Answer all **Twenty** questions in the **OMR Sheet** provided. Each question carries equal marks.

Part – B: Descriptive Answer Questions: Answer **Fivefull** questions choosing **Two full** questions from **Unit – I & Unit – II each** and **One full** question from **Unit – III.**

PART - A: MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

20 Marks

1. Culture is primarily _____.
A) Biological
B) Learned
C) Inherited
D) Static
2. Which text forms the theoretical foundation of Indian classical theatre?
A) Arthashastra
B) Rigveda
C) Natyashastra
D) Sankyashastra
3. What is the primary role of newspapers?
A) Entertainment
B) Informing the public
C) Cultural expression
D) All of these
4. Which of the following languages has the most ancient literary tradition in India?
A) Tamil
B) Hindi
C) Bengali
D) Sanskrit
5. What is the primary function of music in films?
A) Enhancing emotion
B) Adding background noise
C) Distracting the viewer
D) None of these
6. Kambala is associated with which activity?
A) Buffalo racing
B) Fishing
C) Harvesting
D) Boat Racing
7. What does the term "Natyashastra" translate to?
A) Science of music
B) Science of dance
C) Science of drama
D) Science of poetry
8. In Indian cinema, what role does music play?
A) Enhances the storyline
B) Adds emotional depth
C) Both (A) and (B)
D) None of these
9. Which Indian festival is known for showcasing the victory of good over evil?
A) Holi
B) Diwali
C) Pongal
D) Eid
10. Cultural diversity primarily promotes _____.
A) Homogenization
B) Conflict
C) Innovation
D) Alienation
11. The Indian film industry contributes to _____.
A) Cultural decline
B) Economic growth
C) Homogenization
D) Isolation
12. The Harappan civilization is known for which of the following features?
A) Urban planning
B) Nomadic lifestyle
C) Monumental temples
D) Extensive military conquests

13. Which of the following describes 'Parallel Cinema' in India?
 A) Mainstream Bollywood films B) Regional films
 C) Realistic and socially relevant films D) Documentaries
14. The primary audience for Bhoota Kola performances is
 A) Children B) Outsiders
 C) Elders only D) Entire community
15. Which festival is closely linked with Kambala?
 A) Local Tulu festivals B) Diwali
 C) Onam D) Pongal
16. What role do newspapers play in cultural representation?
 A) They focus only on entertainment B) They offer a platform for cultural narratives
 C) They avoid controversial topics D) They do not influence culture
17. Which Indian philosophy emphasizes non-violence (Ahimsa)?
 A) Charvaka B) Nyaya
 C) Vedanta D) Jainism
18. The term "cultural appropriation" refers to
 A) Misusing cultural elements for personal gain B) Preserving traditions
 C) Promoting diversity D) Avoiding globalization
19. Yakshagana themes are primarily derived from
 A) Folktales B) Epics and Puranas
 C) Contemporary events D) Historical accounts
20. Who is considered the father of Indian cinema?
 A) Guru Dutt B) Raj Kapoor
 C) Bimal Roy D) Dadasaheb Phalke

PART - B: DESCRIPTIVE ANSWER QUESTIONS

Unit – I		Marks	BT*	CO*	PO*
1.	a) What are the general characteristics of Culture? Explain.	08	L*2	01	06
	b) What are some challenges to cultural preservation in India, and what efforts are being made to address them?	08	L1	01	09
2.	a) Explain the influence of culture highlighting the key dimensions.	08	L2	02	06
	b) Write a note on i. Gender Fluidity and Non-Binary Identities. ii. Material Culture and Non-material Culture	08	L1	02	06
3.	a) Discuss the application of the Sapir-Whorf Hypothesis in the context of Indian languages and its impact on cultural perceptions.	08	L2	02	09
	b) What are the major components (expressions or manifestations) of culture, and how do they interconnect?	08	L1	01	06
Unit – II					
4.	a) Discuss the role and functions of newspapers in society and analyze their impact on public opinion.	08	L3	3	6
	b) Discuss the philosophical contributions of the Upanishads.	08	L3	3	6
5.	a) Write a note on contributions of famous Sanskrit authors of Gupta period.	08	L1	2	6
	b) What are the common themes in Dalit literature? Explain.	08	L2	3	6
6.	a) Write note on: i. Varna system during Vedic period ii. Chaturashrama system and Chaturvidha -purusharthas	08	L1	4	9
	b) Explain functions and types of advertisements highlighting their impact on Indian culture and consumerism.	08	L3	4	9

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Unit – III

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7.	a)	Explain briefly the types of ritual performances in Indian theatre.	06	L2	5	6
	b)	Discuss the ecological significance of Kambala in the Tulu region.	10	L2	5	9
8.	a)	Analyze the social and cultural role of Tuluva festivals like Aati and Pilivesha in shaping the identity of the Tulu-speaking community. How do these practices reflect the values and beliefs of the people?	06	L4	5	6
	b)	Analyze the role of Nagaradhane (serpent worship) in Tuluva culture. Explain its origins, the rituals involved, and its social and environmental impact.	10	L4	5	9

BT* Bloom's Taxonomy, L* Level; CO* Course Outcome; PO* Program Outcome
